



SPEAKER & BRIEFINGS · PRC IMPACT

Tania Johns, MPA

Founder & Principal, PRC Impact · Qualitative Researcher · Civic Strategist · RIVA-Trained
Focus Group Moderator

Tania Johns has spent two decades in rooms with residents, voters, patients, and stakeholders — asking the questions institutions forget to ask before they make expensive, public, hard-to-reverse decisions. Her sessions are built on original fieldwork, not commentary.

61.1%

Yes vote on the 2020 Montgomery County school property tax referendum, in a state where school tax measures routinely fail

10 → 22

Mills approved, generating roughly \$33 million per year for Montgomery Public Schools

20+ yrs

Qualitative research, civic strategy, and campaign experience across the South and nationally

Senior-led

The principal designs the research, moderates the sessions, and delivers the talk. No handoff.

SIGNATURE SESSIONS

Nobody Asked Us: What Communities Actually Say About Data Centers

AI infrastructure is arriving in Southern towns faster than the public process built to absorb it. Separates what communities are actually saying from what both sides assume — and what credible input looks like before a vote. For municipal and county officials, planning and utility boards, chambers, civic and environmental organizations.

Before the Vote: Designing Community Input That Holds Up Under Pressure

How to design listening that produces evidence a council, board, or funder can defend — who you are missing, what to ask, and how to know the answer you got is real. For public agencies, planners, engagement and communications teams, and coalitions facing a referendum.

The Trust Gap: Why Communities Say No to Things That Would Help Them

Nonparticipation is read as apathy. It almost never is. Reframes low turnout, low uptake, and low response as information about trust, access, and relevance. For foundations, nonprofit leadership, public health, and civic organizations.

AI Literacy Isn't the Divide — Trust Is

People who have been surveilled, redlined, or misled by institutions are making a rational calculation about AI, not an uninformed one. What that means for organizations deploying AI in services communities cannot opt out of. For nonprofits, foundations, public agencies, and higher education.

What Actually Gets Through: Writing for How People Really Read

Built on national research with prescribers and message testing with voters and residents: the gap between what an organization intends to communicate and what an audience under time pressure takes in. For communications teams, health communicators, and public information officers.

Buying Research Well

For the people who commission qualitative work: how to scope it, what a good RFP asks for, which corners cost the most when cut, and whether findings are strong enough to act on. For procurement and program staff, grantmakers, and association professional development tracks.

REQUEST TANIA FOR AN EVENT

prcimpact.com/speaking-briefings
info@prcimpact.com · (334) 429-6994

PRC Impact, LLC

Senior-led qualitative research and civic strategy
Montgomery, Alabama · Serving the South and nationally

FORMATS

- **Keynote** — 30 to 45 minutes, with or without moderated question time.
- **Breakout or workshop** — 60 to 90 minutes, participatory. Attendees leave with a framework or instrument they can use.
- **Panel participation or moderation** — available as panelist or moderator. Moderation is a trained skill, and it is one of hers.
- **Board or leadership briefing** — 45 to 60 minutes, closed, tailored to a decision the body currently faces.
- **Private institutional briefing** — confidential, built from the client's own context.
- **Training and facilitation** — half-day and full-day sessions on qualitative methods, listening session design, and facilitation practice.

SELECTED RESEARCH BEHIND THE SESSIONS

Montgomery Public Schools property tax referendum · Montgomery, Alabama

Led qualitative research and civic strategy supporting planning, audience understanding, and engagement design ahead of a 2020 vote that raised the property tax rate from 10 to 22 mills, passing 61.1 percent to 38.9 percent. Credit for the outcome belongs to Montgomery Public Schools, the coalition, elected officials, and the voters who carried it.

Violence prevention community listening · Birmingham, Alabama

Conducted qualitative listening with residents and community stakeholders, surfacing neighborhood-level perspectives on safety, trust, and what was working. PRC Impact contributed research and analysis; it did not run programs, deploy interrupters, or patrol neighborhoods.

Prescriber comprehension research · National, health communications

Senior-led in-depth interviews on how clinical materials land under real time pressure. Materials that front-loaded clinical context were read efficiently; language mirroring institutional framing created friction and got skipped. Client and product confidential.

BACKGROUND

- Founder and Principal, PRC Impact — senior-led qualitative research and civic strategy for public agencies, nonprofits, foundations, coalitions, and mission-driven organizations.
- Deputy Campaign Manager for the historic campaign that elected Montgomery's first Black mayor.
- Prior experience at a national polling and public opinion research firm.
- Leadership roles in multi-state civic engagement work.
- RIVA-trained focus group moderator and qualitative researcher.
- Master of Public Administration, Auburn University at Montgomery — concentration in healthcare administration and policy.
- Graduate of Alabama State University.
- Certified in AI consulting, prompt design, and instructional design, with ongoing study in the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the EU AI Act.

BOOKING NOTES

- Honoraria vary by format, preparation, audience, and travel. Share the event, format, and budget range and you will get a direct answer.
- Available in person across Alabama and the South and nationally, and virtually.
- Every session is adapted to the audience and the decision in front of them.
- She speaks as a researcher, not an advocate — including on live issues such as data center siting.

REQUEST TANIA FOR AN EVENT

prcimpact.com/speaking-briefings
info@prcimpact.com · (334) 429-6994

PRC Impact, LLC

Senior-led qualitative research and civic strategy
Montgomery, Alabama · Serving the South and nationally